offering a large number of ‘mithuns’ (a prized animal of the oxen family) as bride price, is still fondly remembered by many Arunachalis!

It is a sensitive state as the Chinese continue to wrongly show a major part of it in their maps as their territory. Therefore, the state cannot be allowed to be destabilized either politically or from the law-and-order point of view, and development has to be given the highest priority. The feeling that I couldn’t have got a more challenging assignment gave me immense satisfaction.

On my swearing-in on 27 January 2008, I silently prayed for courage, strength and wisdom to live up to the expectations of the people and do justice to the oath that I was taking. Almost twenty-seven years ago, I was the commanding officer of 9 Maratha Light Infantry, which was one of the units tasked to defend our borders in Tezu district. Little did I realize then that one day I shall be back in Arunachal Pradesh as its first citizen. However, when I look back to the two-and-a-half years spent by me in the state in the early 1980s, it is disheartening to see that not much development appears to have taken place in all these years. Although there was some development of infrastructure, more could have been achieved. Very little was done as far as tourism was concerned. Further, there was no industry worth the name. So, there was indeed a challenge for all of us in Arunachal to give greater momentum to development in all spheres.